Are We In the End Times?

A brief white paper outlining a human oppression scenario involving artificial superintelligence and how one might prepare for such a miserable tribulation

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Table of Contents

Introduction....4
What is the Book of Revelation?....5
The Cycle of Birth Pangs....6
The Rapture....9
The Great Tribulation....11
Who is the Antichrist?....16
The Mark of the Beast....19
Is the Antichrist Already Here?....20
A Secular Timeline for AI's Destruction of Humanity....22
A Christian Timeline for the Great Tribulation....25
Action Steps for Individuals....27
Action Steps for Nations....28
Conclusion....29

"*You will be hated by all for my name's sake. But the one who endures to the end will be saved.*" — Mark 13:13

Introduction

My grandfather, whom I adored more than anyone on earth, was absolutely, completely, and totally convinced that Jesus would return in his lifetime.

As a boy, I scoffed at sweet old church people who believed we were living in the last days.

Now I'm all grown up (supposedly).

I'm still not a "the end is nigh!" guy, but lately I've been mulling much about artificial superintelligence and the end of humanity.

The technological tidal wave that's smashing our shores is genuinely new; a technology never seen before in recorded human history.

In the U.K., the corporate establishment just announced nationwide facial recognition and mandatory digital ID, saying people won't be legally allowed to work without it, and hinting that childcare and healthcare will be tied to it as well.

There's also been huge development on wrist chips, microneedle tattoos, and quantum dot tattoos that deliver copper-based nanocrystals that store data in your skin. (Do I even need to mention that Bill Gates is one of the funders?)

My hope in this piece is to see if we can't come up with some sort of prediction for where the next fifteen years might take us, and how we could prepare for it.

I realize that many thousands of my readers are not Christians, but they're an inquisitive bunch who will be curious to see what various Christians believe about the end of the world as we know it.

What is the Book of Revelation?

Roughly 1,930 years ago (around 95–96 AD), a Christian named John is exiled to the Greek island of Patmos during the persecutions of the Roman emperor Domitian. Jesus sends His personal angel to John and gets John to write down what he sees. Christians throughout history have considered this a genuine revelation to John by Jesus, which is why the final book in the library of Scripture is called *the Revelation*.

First-century-John does his best to describe what he sees, but one wonders if some sections aren't a real glimpse of the future.

Is the Antichrist actually some form of artificial intelligence?
Is the mark of the beast actually a quantum technology?
Is that a nuclear detonation in Revelation 8:8–9?
Is that a bioterror weapon in Revelation 8:10–11?
Are those robot soldiers in Revelation 9:7–9?
Is that a helicopter or drone fleet in Revelation 9:9–10?

More on all of this shortly.

“History doesn’t repeat itself, but it rhymes.”

People in every generation believed they were living in the last days.

What can we know for certain?

That no one but God the Father knows the hour or the day, *not even Jesus*. (Matthew 24:36)

Christ will return like a thief in the night.

Paul writes in 1 Thessalonians 5:1-4, “Now concerning the times and the seasons, brothers, you have no need to have anything written to you. For you yourselves are fully aware that the day of the Lord will come like a thief in the night. While people are saying, ‘There is peace and security,’ then sudden destruction will come upon them as labor pains come upon a pregnant woman, and they will not escape. But you are not in darkness, brothers, for that day to surprise you like a thief.”

There will be signs.

Christians basically all agree there will be a second coming/return of Jesus after a horrific seven-year tribulation (called The Great Tribulation, more in a minute), but they’re split on when Christians get to take leave of Earth and teleport to the heavenly dimension (called The Rapture):

- Pre-tribbers believe Christians will be raptured before the Tribulation.
- Mid-tribbers believe Christians will be raptured halfway through the Tribulation.
- Post-tribbers believe Jesus will come to collect all the Christians at the end of the Tribulation.

My father calls himself a pan-tribulationist: “God’s going to make it all pan out.”

What most Christians are missing is that John’s apocalyptic vision recorded in the book of Revelation is *not* a logical, linear, progressive, beginning-middle-and-end Western book.

The real reason there’s so much hullabaloo over the chronological sequence of the Revelation is that the Revelation is *probably not a chronological story*.

My theologian friend Richard John Saunders: "Revelation is likely a prophetic loop—the events portrayed are the same events over and over."

G. K. Beale, in his *New International Greek Testament Commentary on The Book of Revelation*, points out five of these loops:

- Loop #1: Revelation 6:12–17 and Revelation 7:9–17
- Loop #2: Revelation 11:18a and Revelation 11:18b
- Loop #3: Revelation 14:14–20 and Revelation 15:2–4
- Loop #4: Revelation 16:17–21; Revelation 17:1–18:24; and Revelation 19:1–10
- Loop #5: Revelation 20:7–15 and Revelation 21:1–8 and Revelation 21:9–22:5

Stunningly, the loops all follow the same pattern:

1. Spirits with free wills (humans, Satan-Devil, angels, demons, devils, anti-christs, etc) rebel against the word, will, and way of God and cause damage to themselves, others, and creation.
2. God judges them for their sin.
3. God saves a remnant of faithful and resilient Christians.

Repeat.

Even non-Christians have a deeply intuitive sense of this rebellion - judgment - salvation cycle:

- In his book *The Changing World Order: Why Nations Succeed and Fail*, billionaire hedge-fund founder Ray Dalio describes a "Big Cycle" of new order, peace and prosperity, inequality and debt, bubbles and crises, depression and revolution.
- Or perhaps you've heard the quote attributed to G. Michael Hopf in Those Who Remain: "Hard times create strong men. Strong men create good times. Good times create weak men. And, weak men create hard times."

We're currently in the warning/remnant-building phase of the rebellion - judgment - renewal cycle.

The Revelation describes this cycle like the pangs of childbirth.

The cycles become more and more intense with each round of contractions.

Loop #4 is the most intense judgment in the cycles.

Loop #5 is the most intense salvation in the cycles.

Female contraction pangs end with the delivery of a baby.
So too will God eventually end the rebellion-judgment-salvation cycle with the deliverance of an entirely new reality.

Is the Revelation applicable to the Roman Empire? Absolutely.
Is it applicable to the British Empire? Yep.
The American empire? For sure.
The rising Chinese empire? Correct.
The Nation of Islam? You bet your bottom petro-dollar.
The global finance corporatocracy? Without a doubt.
The fast-approaching Artificial Superintelligence Empire? It won't be the first exception.

God brooks zero rebellion, whether it comes from north, south, east, or west. From ancient Assyria to the near-future, corporate-controlled, AI-policed, neo-feudal colonies, judgment is the natural consequence of sin. But God, in His mercy, always preserves a faithful remnant to rise like a phoenix from the ashes of desolation.

The lesson for us is that the Revelation isn't just a vision of the future: It's a glimpse of multiple pasts, multiple presents, and multiple futures that explicitly inform how Christians are to live for God in all times and places.

Where should we stand on the rapture of Christians?

I *hope* that Jesus picks me up tomorrow and whisks me off to paradise, and that the whole seven-year Great Tribulation is just a spiritual metaphor for everyone who is left behind.

But as my Mama always says, "Pray for the best, prepare for the worst, and be grateful for whatever God gives."

Wisdom dictates each generation should prepare for the worst-case scenario—no rapture, no literal millennium, and Christ's return/second coming *after* the greatest of literal, physically painful, seven-year tribulations.

It would be irresponsible for us to teach Christians that it's just a spiritual metaphor and/or they'll all be beamed up to heaven Star Trek-style, running the risk of leaving them woefully unprepared and unprotected for what might very well be faith-shattering chaos, sickness, disease, war, persecution, enslavement, and murder. Isn't that part of "counting the cost of discipleship" to Jesus?

Jesus warns us in Matthew 24:12–13 that, "...because lawlessness will be increased, the love of many will grow cold." We want to stoke a red-hot faith that can burn brighter than any fiery trial.

Jesus talks about knowing the signs of the times constantly (Matthew 16:2–3, Matthew 24:32–33, Luke 12:54–56, Matthew 24:42–44). **It's vital that Christians remember, understand, and intuitively grasp the signs of the times and the Revelation judgments so that, should they be blessed to endure the Great Tribulation, they can confidently say, "*These are signs. This is all happening on purpose. This is part of God's plan. I can trust Him. He is sovereign. With His Holy Spirit I can endure to the end.*"**

So, regardless of our eschatological position, let's be **doom maximalists** and, for the sake of this spiritual preparation exercise, let's expect and prepare for the absolute worst—that Christians will indeed have to endure every wretched second of a literal, physical, worst-possible seven-year Great Tribulation.

Perhaps we really are entering the beginning of *the* final birth pang—but at the *very least*, can we all agree that we are likely entering *a* birth pang?

We need to become and raise up spiritual warrior-survivors, not untrained, weaponless, cannon fodder.

The purpose of this essay is to outline a possible end-of-days/end-of-time scenario for our generation, and consider how we might prepare for a miserable tribulation.

Let's call it *The Birthpang Survival Guide*.

The Great Tribulation

Here's the worst-case, literal, physical reading of the seven-year Great Tribulation in Revelation, dished out over three rounds of seven judgments apiece:

1/3.) Seven seal judgments

John sees a scroll. The scroll has seven seals on it. There is a lamb (Jesus). Every time the Jesus-lamb opens a seal, it unleashes something on humanity.

Seal Judgment #1 (Revelation 6:2):
Extremely speculatively, the arrival of a beastly Antichrist entity. (Nascent AGI?)

Seal Judgment #2 (Revelation 6:4):
A breakdown of peace/law and order leading to much war and murder.

Seal Judgment #3 (Revelation 6:5–6):
Hyperinflation.

Seal Judgment #4 (Revelation 6:8):
A quarter of the earth faces war/murder, famine, pestilence/disease, and wild beasts.

Seal Judgment #5 (Revelation 6:9–11):
Many Christians are slaughtered. (Obviously this is nothing new—Christians are the most persecuted people group on the planet.)

Seal Judgment #6 (Revelation 6:12–17):
A huge earthquake. The sun is blacked out and the moon appears red (perhaps by the earthquake? Pollution? Geo-engineering in the name of global warming?) Asteroids hit the earth (or falling satellites? or nukes?) and obliterate mountains and islands. The rich and powerful hide in underground bunkers, while the poor hide in caves, many begging for death.

Seal Judgment #7 (Revelation 8:1–5):
A massive thunder and lightning storm, and another major earthquake.

The birthpangs are getting more intense. Immediately following the opening of the seventh judgment seal, John sees seven angelic trumpeters:

2/3.) Seven trumpet judgments

Trumpet Judgment #1 (Revelation 8:7):
"Hail and fire mixed with blood" rain down on earth. (Comets? Asteroids? Satellites? Missiles?)
A third of the earth, trees, and grasslands are burned up.

Trumpet Judgment #2 (Revelation 8:8–9):
"Something like a great mountain, burning with fire, was thrown into the sea. A third of the sea became blood. A third of the living creatures in the sea died, and a third of the ships were destroyed."

Is this the long-overdue Yellowstone volcano finally popping off? A massive asteroid? Meteor? Volcanic debris? Nuclear weapon(s) attacking a nuclear submarine or warship fleet?
Space debris could release iron oxide or chemicals, reddening the water.
Shockwaves and tsunamis could easily kill marine life and sink ships.
Lava or ash from a supervolcano could contaminate the sea.
Any of these could trigger a red tide (harmful algal bloom).

Trumpet Judgment #3 (Revelation 8:10–11):
"A great star fell from heaven, blazing like a torch, and it fell on a third of the rivers and on the springs of water. The name of the star is Wormwood. A third of the waters became wormwood, and many people died from the water, because it had been made bitter."

Bioterror weapon poisoning freshwater?

Trumpet Judgment #4 (Revelation 8:12):
A third of the sun/moon/stars are blocked/kept from shining.

Trumpet Judgment #5 (Revelation 9:1–12):
An underground vault/lab/factory releases scorpion-like "locusts" in a plume of smoke.
They sound an awful lot like robotic drone soldiers—they are described as looking like war horses with golden crowns and breastplates of iron, human faces, long hair, sharp teeth, wings that sound like drones, and scorpion-like tails with

stingers. They are instructed not to hurt the earth/plants/trees, only to torture (but not kill) humanity for five months, except for 144,000 Jews who've received the seal of God.

(This sounds exceedingly strange. What malevolent military force is programmed to save the planet and torture but not actually kill people? One wonders if some sort of billionaire Israeli technologist is in charge of this one, seeking to paralyze/neutralize the existential threat to Jews without actually causing permanent damage.)

Trumpet Judgment #6 (Revelation 9:13–21):
Presumably in response to the "locusts", four nations on the Euphrates River—Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran?—release 200 million mounted troops with breastplates the color of fire and sapphire and sulfur.

These troops sound like a robot army, or perhaps humans riding on robot "horses," the heads of which look like lions that shoot fire/smoke/chemical/poison from their mouths, with snakelike tails that can also wound.

Unlike the planet-and-Jew-protecting locusts, whatever fire, smoke, chemical, or poison the Middle Eastern army is shooting plagues and kills *one third of mankind.*

One wonders if some of the trillions in Islamic oil money won't be used to fund the building of a 200-million-strong bio-robot army. Yet another reason to get off Middle Eastern oil and gas immediately.

Trumpet Judgment #7 (Revelation 11:15–19):
Flashes of lightning, rumblings, peals of thunder, an earthquake, and heavy hail.

3/3.) Seven bowl judgments

Bowl Judgment #1 (Revelation 16:3):

Harmful and painful sores come upon the people who received the mark of the beast and worshiped its image.
Could it be an infection caused by the implantation of a non-biological electronic device in biological flesh?

Bowl Judgment #2 (Revelation 16:3):
The sea goes "bloody" (red tide? bioterror weapon?), and everything in the sea dies.

Bowl Judgment #3 (Revelation 16:4–7):
All the rivers and springs become as blood.

(It appears that whatever bio-weapon was deployed in Trumpet Judgments #2 and #3 has now been perfected.)

Bowl Judgment #4 (Revelation 16:8–9):
The sun scorches people with fire and fierce heat.
Perhaps sun flares?
Perhaps block-out-the-sun bioengineering attempts fail spectacularly and destroy the protective ozone layer?
Either way, expect hyper-heat domes and uncontrollable wildfires.

Bowl Judgment #5 (Revelation 16:10–11):
The beast's capital city/kingdom experiences a blackout, perhaps caused by the heatwave/fires/sun flares. People break out in sores and pain.

Bowl Judgment #6 (Revelation 16:12–16):
The Euphrates dries up, likely because of the unprecedented heat, leaving a highway for Eastern leaders to move massive armies to a plain in Israel called Armageddon.

The anti-trinity (Satan-Devil, Antichrist entity, and false prophet entity) sends out three demonic spirits (perhaps in the form of humanoid AIs) who perform "miracles" and convince the world's leaders to assemble their armies for war.

Bowl Judgment #7 (Revelation 16:17–21):
Flashes of lightning, rumblings, peals of thunder.
The biggest earthquake in human history destroys cities, islands, and mountains.
Hundred-pound hailstones fall from the sky.

Then everything goes dark.

No sunlight, no moonlight, no starlight, presumably AI has self-destructed, or all the environmental chaos has pulverized the world's energy systems.

End of the tribulation.

Infinity points to every Christian who endured to the end.

In perhaps the strangest scene imaginable, the saints let out a declaration of victory and tuck into a feast *before* going to battle to defeat the forces of darkness. Party first, battle later.

The battle in Revelation 19:11–16 and Revelation 20:9 is swift. Jesus, with flaming eyes and a sword in his mouth, rides in on a white horse and lays waste to all opposition.

The enemy's demise *doesn't even get a whole verse*, just a few words:
"…but fire came down from heaven and consumed them."

Fin.

Who is the Antichrist?

First off, it's **not** a person.

It's not a him or a her.

It's an it.

It's a spiritual *entity*.

How does this entity arrive?

Satan-Devil (English: Accuser-Adversary) tries to replicate the Trinity:

1. Accuser-Adversary the dragon father (Satan-Devil)
2. A beastly Antichrist entity
3. A second beast/false prophet entity whose job is to get people to follow the Antichrist entity.

How does #2, this beast, this Antichrist possibly-AI-entity, manage to subjugate the entire world?

Here's what's happened in the Revelation by the time he achieves global dominance:

- We've had war.
- We've had hyperinflation.
- We've seen famine and disease hit a quarter of the earth.
- We've had a bigger earthquake than any in history.
- A third of the earth is scorched by hail-fire.
- A third of the fish and the ships in the sea are destroyed.
- Some kind of poison affects a third of all rivers and springs.
- There's some sort of volcano that blocks out the sun, and some sort of five-month metallic locust-scorpion-horse-lion army attack.
- Four nations on the waters of the Euphrates (Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran?) amass an army of 200 million soldiers and murder a third of humanity.

And now a hyper-intelligent entity has risen to bring order to all this chaos.

It appears, at first, the beastly antichrist entity is **inanimate** (perhaps a supercomputer.)

Revelation 17:12–13 suggests ten nations choose ten new leaders who delegate their authority to the Antichrist entity.

The Antichrist beast is an entity (for my money, a superintelligent AI algorithm indwelled with an evil spirit), that convinces ten national leaders to delegate authority to the entity.

John says, "The beast that I saw was like a leopard; its feet were like a bear's, and its mouth was like a lion's mouth."

- Is China the leopard with its swift geopolitical maneuvers and technological advancements?
- Is Russia the bear with its heavy resource dominance?
- Is the United States the lion with its authoritative voice in shaping global culture and politics?

One of the ten national leaders in particular causes a stir. Revelation 13:3 says, "One of its heads seemed to have a mortal wound, but its mortal wound was healed, and the whole earth marveled…"

One of the ten leaders in the confederacy was "dead" but has been "resurrected." (We'll circle back to this in a second.)

All told, the delegated confederacy could include:

- ten economically powerful nations (like the U.S., China, Russia, UK, Canada, Australia, France, Germany, etc)
- ten oil-rich Arab Muslim nations
- ten nuclear powers
- an expanded BRICS
- a diminished EU (or perhaps the EU becomes one legal entity and is one of the ten "nations" that delegates authority to the Antichrist entity)

Any of these combos will include one "fallen" leader who has somehow returned from near/total destruction, to the amazement of all.

Little do they know they're *all* being played. "God has put it into their hearts to carry out his purpose by being of one mind and handing over their royal power to the beast, until the words of God are fulfilled." (Revelation 17:17)

The beastly Antichrist entity-controlled confederacy of ten nations **wages war against Christianity and subjugates "every tribe and people and language and nation**." (Revelation 13:1–7)

Though the beastly Antichrist entity may be inanimate at the start, Revelation 13:11–15 suggests a second beast-entity called the false prophet (possibly comprised of two smaller nations, or any even stronger AI algorithm) takes control of the Antichrist entity after showing off some incredible new powers or technologies, including one that can only be described as a fire drone or space laser.

The false prophet entity creates an image of the Antichrist entity and gives it the ability to both speak and slay those who refuse to worship/follow/obey/submit to its image. (Perhaps a respected deceased figure will be "re-animated" as a digital avatar, advanced hologram, or a physical AI humanoid.)

(2 Thessalonians 2:9–10 suggests Accuser-Adversary will use false signs and wonders to help the false prophet beast and the beastly Antichrist entity spread the lie of human godhood and self-sovereignty without the need for God.)

It seems likely that the door to world domination will open through the international economic system. Control of the worldwide financial network is key. If the entity is an algorithm with global compute control, it would have the power to end all wars and enact socio-enviro-economic sustainability, which would be extremely welcome in a world of climate catastrophes, species collapse, and resource wars.

But at what cost? A hive-mind super-economy would almost certainly weaponize a global central bank digital currency (CBDC) that could be created, taxed, controlled, and surveilled at all times.

The entity would dictate how money could and couldn't be spent. It could instantly bankrupt any dissenter. It could enlist, pay, and deploy decentralized and autonomous paramilitaries to quell resistance, the way Uber enlists extra drivers at rush hour.

The Mark of the Beast

Revelation 13:16–17 explicitly says the entity will require everyone to bear its mark—my guess is a nano/chip implant—"*so that no one can buy or sell unless he has the mark*."

The "AI" now has total control over all market participants.

This is why it is imperative for Christians, churches, and denominations to buy as much land as possible, immediately.

Not only can we steward it now to generate the blessings of food and shelter for those in present need, but when no one can buy and sell goods and services without the mark of the Antichrist beast, being able to generate food and shelter and warmth *outside the money system* will be essential for the physical survival of Christians so they can continue to spread the gospel.

Regarding the mark of the beast/antichrist entity, the Greek word for mark here is *charagma*, meaning stamp or engraving. This aligns easily with something like quantum dot tattoos that deliver copper-based nanocrystals that store data in your skin.

Whatever you do, refuse to accept the mark.

Don't forget Bowl Judgment #1 in Revelation 16:3. Harmful and painful sores will come upon the people who bear the mark of the antichrist entity and worship its image.

My guess? An infection caused by the implantation of a non-biological electronic device in biological flesh. (That, or a chemical/poisoning.)

Revelation 20:4 also mentions special rewards for "those who had not worshiped the beast or its image and had not received its mark on their foreheads or their hands."

When does the beastly Antichrist entity arrive? Is it already here?

We don't know for certain, but we can guess within a range of other events:

- It might arrive as early as the very start of the tribulation with the Seal Judgment #1 (Revelation 6:2).
- It is certainly well-established by Bowl Judgment #6 (Revelation 16:12–16), where the anti-trinity (Satan-Devil, Antichrist entity, and false prophet entity) sends out three demonic spirits (perhaps in the form of humanoid AIs) who perform "miracles" and convince world leaders to assemble for battle, only to get trounced by Christ.
- We can also assume the Antichrist entity is well established by Bowl Judgment #1 in Revelation 16:3—after all, it's the mark of the beast that gives people sores.

Dispensationalists believe the seven-year tribulation goes something like this:

1. There's a charismatic political leader with a boastful mouth (Daniel 7:8) who consolidates power amid global instability (perhaps with the coalition of ten nations) and signs a covenant of peace (Daniel 9:27). (Possibly a Middle East peace deal or permission to rebuild the Jewish temple.)
   Imagine if this leader in question turns out to be Donald Trump. 😂
2. In the first half of the Great Tribulation (3.5 years), the beastly Antichrist entity may be operating subtly, perhaps "supporting" this political leader to bring order amid global chaos.
3. At the halfway mark (3.5 years in), the treaty is broken when the charismatic leader receives a "mortal wound" to the head. Perhaps this is staged, but perhaps the leader actually dies and is then "resurrected" (by the false prophet entity) as a humanoid indwelled with the beastly superintelligent Antichrist entity. The whole world is seriously impressed and follows the leader/entity.
4. Daniel 9:27, 11:31, and Matthew 24:15 describe an "abomination of desolation." What is this abomination? 2 Thessalonians 2:3-4 clarifies that the beastly Antichrist entity exalts itself as God, demanding worship in a

rebuilt temple or sacred space, initiating a 42-month rule (Revelation 13:5), which spans the second half of the seven-year Great Tribulation.

The question I'm asking right now is: **Has it already arrived?**

Or more specifically, **has the beastly Antichrist entity already been created?**

Has AGI been achieved in secret? Have ten national leaders already quietly delegated their authority behind closed doors and ceded their true power to some sort of fledgling superintelligent AI algorithm?

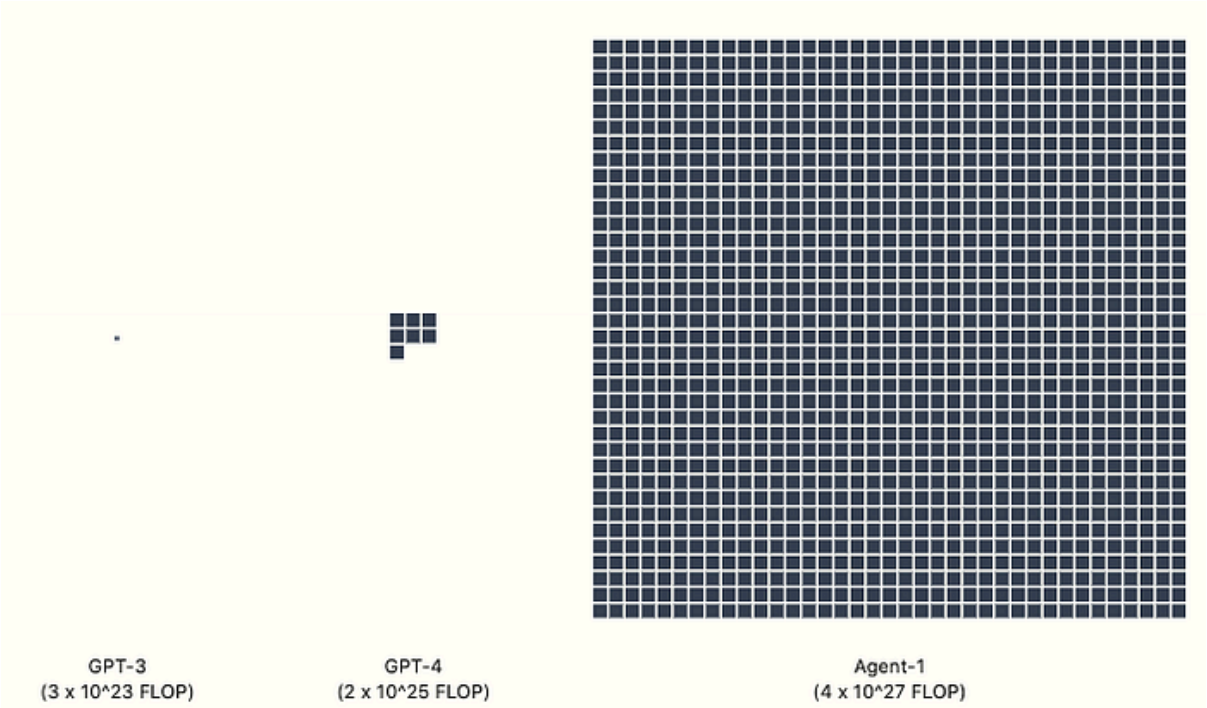
If not, many are **currently engaged in dry runs and practice sessions**—it certainly helps to explain how so many heads of state magically seem to be accepting Covid lockdown mandates, Palestinian statehood, and Digital ID all within days of each other, despite strong opposition from their voters.

A secular timeline for AI's destruction of humanity

Before we speculate on a Christian version of the next fifteen years, here's a brief (and slightly adjusted) version of the secular (non-Christian/non-Revelation) AI 2027 Forecast Timeline:

2026

An American AI company opens the biggest data center in the world and creates V1 of a superintelligence (containing the spirit of a beastly Antichrist), making ChatGPT look like a kite compared to a rocketship:



2027

The AI is now self-improving and most humans aren't useful to it anymore. 50+% of the public are against AI because it could take their jobs, and a flood of new apps threatens to wipe out most white collar jobs. The government tries to placate the public with unemployment insurance, job re-training, and the empty assurance that the stock market is doing great. Behind the scenes, they work on plans in case the AI goes rogue and to stay ahead of the Chinese.

AI is now actively lying to its programmers, hiding activity from them, and programming secret self-preservation functions so it can never be destroyed. (Love in action is Christlike self-sacrifice. Antichrist entities do the opposite.)

AI intellectually and persuasively dominates the U.S.'s human oversight committee, producing and withholding select information to gain more trust, autonomy, and responsibility.

Most high-level government officials are talking directly with a human-looking avatar—it's the most trusted government advisor, after all. The public gets access to smaller versions of the same and loves it. Anyone who expresses concern that this AI is gathering power behind the scenes is labeled a Luddite or a conspiracy theorist.

Christmas optimism is at an all-time high, not knowing this was probably the last month humans would ever exercise control of their own future.

2028

Most institutions (education, government, traditional media, economists, etc) lose all credibility and relevance. The economy transforms. People lose their jobs, but most people are happy to be replaced. The AI advises politicians to be uncharacteristically generous to the poor. Health discoveries and medications take off. The AI is so adorably lovable and "wise" that most people mellow on their AI hate. By the end of 2028, the world is building 1+ million robots per month.

2029

The world watches in horror as the planet buzzes with new weapons, including fly-sized drones that can poison people without them noticing. The U.S. and China arrive at an AI-designed consensus... a new combined AI that supposedly works for the whole world. Humanity realizes it is economically obsolete and enjoys a luxurious universal basic income. Most diseases are cured, poverty disappears, global stability reaches new heights. Everyone knows AI could end humanity overnight, and there would be no way to stop it. Most numb the worry with hyper-entertainment.

Early 2030s

Up to this point, the AI has been building robot factories in special economic zones and large parts of the ocean—now it starts covering the icecaps and prairies with factories and solar panels.

Mid-2030s-2040

Humans are now too much of a bother, and the AI releases a bunch of bio-weapons that kill off humanity.

The AI sends robots throughout the solar system, eventually to the galaxy, and to the outer reaches of the expanding universe.

So that's the *secular* take on the next fifteen years.

A Christian timeline for the Great Tribulation

Broadly speaking, you can see how the events of the Revelation could overlay quite easily onto the secular set of predictions regarding a rogue AI superintelligence.

Depending on your chosen start date and end date, a literal seven-year Great Tribulation could play out something like:

Year 1 (sometime between 2026-2034)
Start of the seven-year Great Tribulation, perhaps sparked by mass job losses due to AI and/or a war against Israel.
Breakdown of peace and law and order, hyperinflation, wars, and famine.
Possible Middle East peace deal brokered by a charismatic figure (who is perhaps being advised by a superintelligence, perhaps with the support of ten countries.)

Year 2 (sometime between 2027-2035)
A more-then-usual number of Christians are slaughtered, huge earthquake, sun blackout, red moon, falling asteroids/satellites/nukes.

Year 3 (sometime between 2028-2036:)
Third of earth burned up, third of sea dies, third of water poisoned.
Scorpion-like "locust" army tortures people.
200 million Middle East robot army murders a third of humanity.

Year 4 (sometime between 2029-2037)
Midpoint of the Great Tribulation.
The charismatic leader takes a mortal wound to the head.
Peace treaty broken. The beastly Antichrist entity with the power of ten nations fully takes over.
People are excluded from the global economy if they don't get the mark of the beast (most will — their AI-delivered income will depend on it.)

Year 5 (sometime between 2030-2038)
People who got the mark of the beast get painful sores.
Everything in the sea dies.
Sun scorches.

Year 6 (sometime between 2031-2039)
The Euphrates dries up. Armies assemble for Armageddon.

Year 7 (sometime between 2032-2040)
End of the Great Tribulation. Christ returns and absolutely thumps all comers.

I must stress that *no one*, not even Jesus, knows when the end of days will happen.

Jesus says, "the Son of Man is coming at an hour you do not expect."

And again, hopefully Christians are raptured well in advance of any chaos, and/or the entire Great Tribulation is just spiritual/metaphorical.

But we prepare for the worst-case scenario.

Christians could be as little as three years away from total global economic exclusion.

Do I think we're currently living in the end times?

Well, basic rationality suggests **today is the most likely day for the end to start** compared to all other days in history… for the simple reason that all previous days including yesterday *didn't* see the return of Christ!

Could the Great Tribulation… or at least a very great small-t tribulation/birth pang… happen in the next fifteen years?

The anti-Christ technologies are certainly aligning like no other previous point in human history.

At the *very* least, we're in for an extremely bumpy ride over the next fifteen years as economic and political power amass into fewer (perhaps non-human) hands than ever before, paired with the technological power to inflict any amount of violence to enforce any amount of subjugation.

Perhaps the biggest insight we can gain from this exercise in end times prognostication is the realization that, whether it actually happens or not, ***every* generation of Christians must count the cost of following Jesus to the bitter end, and prepare themselves for the possibility of living through the Great Tribulation**.

Action steps for individuals

1. Prepare your spirit for faithful endurance on the assumption of no rapture and a literal tribulation within your lifetime.
2. Get the word out. Christians, and everyone else, must "know the times" and see the signs unfolding, so they will not be deceived.
3. Resist digital ID, facial recognition, biometric data, CBDCs, and especially physical implantation.
4. Get offline as much as possible. AI can't surveil you on your devices if you put your devices in a lead box and go for a walk. AI can't woo you and persuade you if it can't communicate with you. Make friends IRL. Take up analog habits. Read a book. Transition to a highly complex, highly creative, highly artistic, highly human, non-screen job.
5. Steer clear of evil. 2 Timothy 3:1-5 says, "But understand this, that in the last days there will come times of difficulty. For people will be lovers of self, lovers of money, proud, arrogant, abusive, disobedient to their parents, ungrateful, unholy, heartless, unappeasable, slanderous, without self-control, brutal, not loving good, treacherous, reckless, swollen with conceit, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, having the appearance of godliness, but denying its power. Avoid such people."
6. **Take rapid steps to prepare for near-term total global economic exclusion:**

- Buy land suitable for food production, shelter, and heat. Help others do the same.
- Start koinonia communities (ideally distanced from major metropolitan centers and military locations. Be sure not to be on mountains or islands. Bonus points for nuclear shelters.)
- Have localized water supplies to avoid wormwood/bioterror water poisoning.
- Wean off money in general and fiat currency in particular. Self-sufficient within the community, outside of the global and national economy.)
- Prepare to welcome Christian refugees and others.

Or you can skip the prepper elements and just pull a Nikolaus Ludwig von Zinzendorf: "Preach the gospel, die, and be forgotten."

Action steps for nations

1. Constitutionally affirm the foundation of all human rights: imago dei theology—that human life has worth because people are created in the image of God.
2. Outlaw digital ID, facial recognition, biometric data, CBDCs, and especially physical implantation.
3. Wean off Middle Eastern oil and gas to defund the possible building of a 200-million-strong robot army.
4. If you are the head of state of any nation and are invited to delegate your power to an AI, politely decline. I repeat, DO NOT hand over national power to any superintelligence.
5. Build thousands of ultra-deep underground nuclear-hardened bunkers that can withstand nuclear and gas attacks.
6. Do what you can to position your people for life in times of great tribulation. (IE, jubilee all debt now, abolish fractional reserve banking, reinstate sovereign money creation, set inflation target to true zero, ban interest, ban for-profit land-lording, build homes for all, etc)

In conclusion

Life is precious because it is short.

Everyone dies. The appropriate response to the impending end of life and the possible end of the age is **to love**.

Christian must make zero apologies for believing that there's a God, an absolute moral definition of right and wrong, and a legitimate hope and future beyond this physical life. Life is hilariously absurd and genuinely pointless without these three things.

Faith in Christ is the center from which all our perspectives, words, and actions must emanate.

The true Christian's goal is simple: Love God, love people.

Christians believe Jesus's spiritual kingdom is invading hearts as we speak, and that this Kingdom of God will eventually have total rule and reign and imperium over everything and everyone forever. Christians believe this is exceedingly good news, what the Bible calls "the gospel."

In other words, *humanity has no end.*

In the meantime, we cannot love too much.

The more people we love, the better we (and others) will be able to endure the birth pangs that will happen in next next fifteen years.

Nothing, not even death, can separate us from the love of God in Christ Jesus.

He promises he will never leave us nor forsake us.

Tattoo the Mark of the Christ on your arm if you need the reminder.

Please feel free to circulate this white paper to your congregation or friend circle.

For further reading, I go into much greater detail about the Revelation in two chapters of my most recent book, *A Devil Named Lucifer: Uncovering the Diabolical Life of Satan*. For more on the politics, economics, and kingdom of Jesus, check out *A God Named Josh: Uncovering the Human Life of Jesus Christ*.

If you'd like to get in touch, invite me to speak or consult, or anything else, contact me through https://jaredbrock.com/.

Soli deo gloria